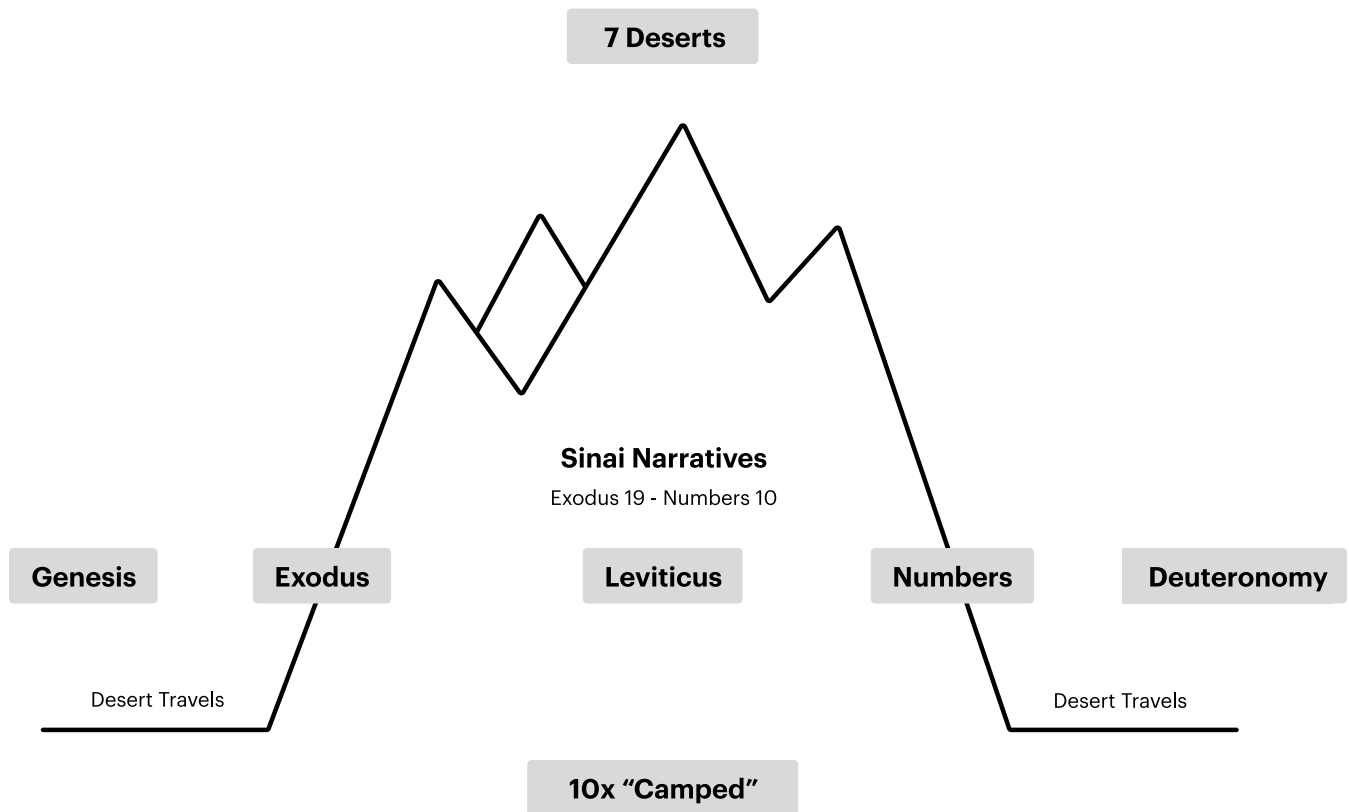


Session 13: Liminal Space

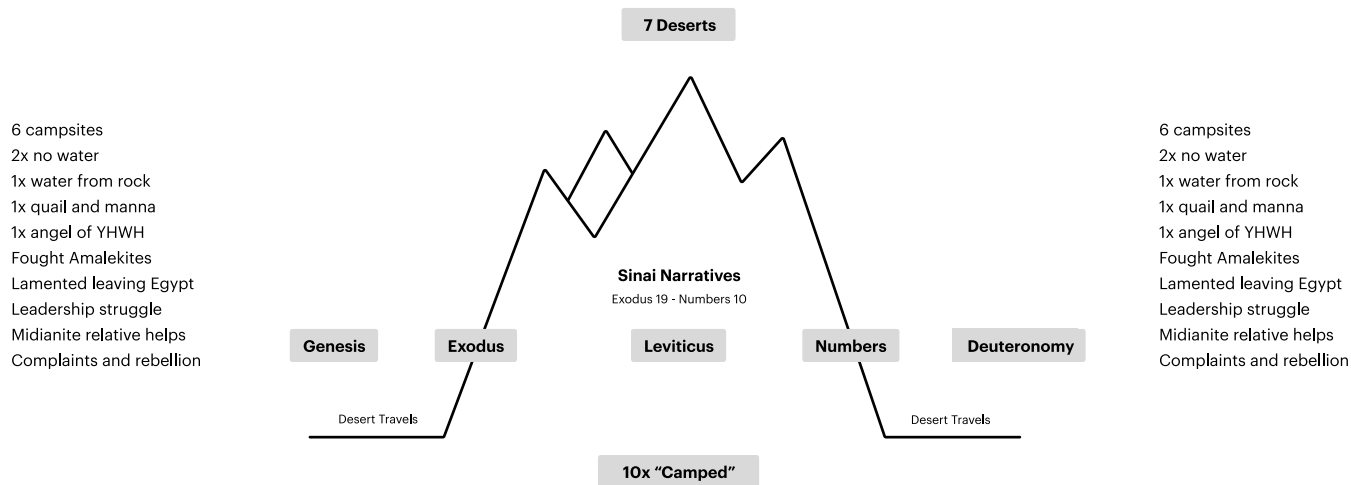
Key Takeaways

- The wilderness narratives recount a liminal space for God to form Israel as a new nation.
- The wilderness narratives in Exodus 15-18 mirror the wilderness journey of Numbers 10-21 in a chiasm that frames the entire Torah.

Sinai at the Center of the Torah



Sinai at the Center of the Torah. Imes, Carmen Joy (2019). *Bearing God's Name: Why Sinai Still Matters*. IVP Academic.
14.



Narrative Frame Around Sinai. Imes, Carmen Joy (2019). *Bearing God's Name: Why Sinai Still Matters*. IVP Academic. 14.

Literary Frame Around the Sinai Narratives

The wilderness wanderings of Exodus and Numbers form a literary frame around the Sinai narratives. On both sides of the time at Sinai, the biblical authors arranged a series of events.

- 6 campsites
- 2x no water
- 1x water from rock
- 1x quail and manna
- 1x angel of YHWH
- Fight Amalekites
- Lament leaving Egypt
- Midianite relative helps
- Complaints and rebellion

Chiasm in the Wilderness Journeys

Exod. 5-15 YHWH's showdown with Pharaoh, king of Egypt

Exod. 14:19-20 Angel of YHWH protects Israel from Egypt's army

Exod. 15 Song of victory over Pharaoh, king of Egypt

Exod. 15:22-25 Springs of water provided

Chiasm in the Wilderness Journeys. Created by Carmen Imes for BibleProject Classroom: Exodus Overview (2021).

The people's ingratitude and rebellion meets God's gracious provision in cycles of work and rest, which result in a contrast between serving YHWH and serving Pharaoh.

Reflection Question

Have you had a season where you experienced what felt like a liminal time? How did that time shape you or help form your identity?